



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 43

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Flooring Installation Safety (Hardwood, LVP, Laminate)

OVERVIEW:

Hardwood, LVP, and laminate flooring installation are physically demanding tasks that involve sustained kneeling, repetitive mallet strikes, pneumatic flooring nailer operation, and precise cutting at floor level. The combination of prolonged postures, repetitive impact, and tool use in tight spaces makes

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The flooring nailer — also called a cleat nailer or stapler — is operated by striking the plunger with a rubber mallet. Every strike drives the nailer's striking plate down, firing a fastener into the flooring and the subfloor. The hazard is that the hand holding the nailer in position is inches from the strike zone, and a strike that misses the plunger or glances off it can drive the nailer.
2. Use the correct mallet for your flooring nailer. Flooring nailers are designed for rubber mallets that absorb impact and drive the plunger cleanly. Using a steel hammer delivers too much force, can damage the nailer's internal components, and transfers excessive impact shock to the wrist and elbow. If you do not have a rubber mallet of adequate weight, stop and get one before continuing.
3. Eye protection is required during flooring installation because cutting hardwood and LVP generates chips that can travel significant distances. Crosscuts on a miter saw or chop saw throw chips backward toward the operator. LVP clicked apart or cut with a score-and-snap tool can send fragments. Chips from hardwood flooring cuts are particularly hard and can cause corneal abrasions.
4. Knee management on flooring jobs is critical because the duration of floor-level work can easily exceed 6 to 8 hours in a day. Wear thick, gel-padded knee pads — not thin foam sliders — for sustained installation work. Take a standing break every 30 minutes to restore blood flow to the knees. If you experience numbness or tingling in the knees, take a break immediately — these are

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Does everyone have the correct knee pads for sustained flooring installation work today?
Q2: What is the correct hand position on the flooring nailer, and can you show me?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Always wear knee pads — flooring is one of the most knee-intensive tasks
- Keep all fingers away from the flooring nailer strike zone at all times
- Use the correct mallet — rubber, not steel — for flooring nailers
- Eye protection is required when cutting — flooring chips fly aggressively
- Keep utility knife blades fresh — dull blades require dangerous extra force

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 43

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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